infrastructure, or financial resources that can be threatened; it has no ideology that is formulated precisely and is an expression of nihilism with a culture of suicide. In such an environment, the cost of victory with a strategy that relies only on response to attack is unacceptably high, so a strategy of prevention is the only answer. A similar logic is also applied in the context of targeted killings. The environment is, as mentioned above, one of ongoing terrorism in the name of God, characterized by methods of action that allow fewer and fewer people to kill more and more people. Thus the side defending itself must focus more and more on the few that are causing the terror. The perpetrators of terrorism are civilians who hide in populated areas. The defenders' methods of action consist of specific, real-time intelligence and the ability to target the individual terrorist who has sought refuge within a community, without harming innocents. In other words, targeted killings are a logical consequence with a moral aspect, since they save innocent lives.

Another reason that a strategy of prevention is justified is the distinct religious—radical Islamist fundamentalist—component that has typified terrorism in recent years. This element makes it impossible to reach a compromise or even to negotiate with the perpetrators of terror, because they aspire to total world domination and see anyone who is not one of them as an enemy to be destroyed by any means necessary. Therefore, there is both a moral and an operational justification to strike the ideologists, messengers, planners, and perpetrators of this terror, and not to wait for them to attack.

(In the case of the Second Gulf War, George W. Bush was apparently also motivated by the desire to take revenge on Saddam Hussein for his intention to assassinate his father while he was visiting Kuwait in 1993 after the end of his term. The administration of Bush's successor, President Clinton, revealed the Iraqi leader's intention, but there were always doubts about the story's accuracy, as there was no real evidence to support it, and over the years the opinion that the story was baseless grew more prevalent. Even so, in September 2002, about six months before the United States launched the Second Gulf War, Bush Junior called Saddam Hussein "the guy who tried to kill my dad.")

Despite the inherent logic in both the preemptive strike theory and targeted killings, the international community has not yet adopted these models in international agreements. Even countries that support these